

FREE GUIDE



6 Anti-Dandruff DIY Recipes

Neem, clay, black seed oil... the homemade treatments that actually calm the scalp — ingredients, prep, application, frequency.

by Schicgirl

Not all dandruff is the same

"Anti-dandruff" isn't one single category. Dandruff has 3 different causes — and each recipe in this guide works best for one of them.

DRY SCALP

Small, fine white flakes, tight/itchy scalp. Often worse in winter or after a stripping shampoo.

BUILDUP

Bigger flakes, scalp feels oily. Too much unrinsed product, or excess sebum.

YEAST (MALASSEZIA)

Persistent flakes despite washing, sometimes itchy. The most common cause of dandruff that keeps coming back.

WHICH RECIPE FOR WHICH CAUSE

Dry scalp → Black seed oil (recipe 3), Pure aloe vera mask (recipe 5).

Buildup → Rhassoul clay mask (recipe 6), Apple cider vinegar rinse (recipe 2).

Yeast / persistent → Neem mask (recipe 1), Diluted tea tree (recipe 4), Apple cider vinegar rinse (recipe 2).

WHEN TO SEE A DOCTOR

These recipes help manage and space out common dandruff. If your scalp stays red, very irritated, or crusty after several weeks of consistent care, or if it doesn't improve at all, book an appointment with a dermatologist. See one promptly if you notice unusual hair loss, patches spreading beyond the scalp (face, ears, neck), oozing, yellowish crusts, or pain or tenderness to the touch — these can be signs of seborrheic dermatitis, an infection, or another condition that needs targeted medical treatment. A dermatologist can give you the right diagnosis and save you months of trial and error.

Recipes 1 to 3

1 • Neem mask ANTIFUNGAL

For: persistent dandruff linked to yeast (*Malassezia*).

INGRÉDIENTS

- 2 tbsp neem powder
- Warm water (for a smooth paste)
- 1 tsp jojoba or coconut oil

APPLICATION

Before shampooing: apply to dry or slightly damp scalp, section by section, using your fingertips (not nails). Rinse thoroughly with your regular shampoo.

PRÉPARATION

Mix the neem powder with warm water little by little until you get a smooth, lump-free paste. Add the oil and mix again.

FRÉQUENCE

1x/week, then every 2 weeks once improved · leave on 20-30 min under a cap

2 • Apple cider vinegar rinse REBALANCING

For: product buildup, oily-feeling scalp, yeast.

INGRÉDIENTS

- 2 tbsp apple cider vinegar (unfiltered)
- 1 cup (250 ml) water

APPLICATION

After shampooing, pour over the scalp, massage 2-3 min with fingertips. Rinse with clean water or let it air-dry (the smell fades as it dries).

PRÉPARATION

Dilute the vinegar in the water. Pour into a bottle or cup for application.

FRÉQUENCE

1-2x/week max · do not use on irritated or broken skin

3 • Black seed oil (nigella) SOOTHING

For: dry, tight scalp that flakes in fine patches.

INGRÉDIENTS

- 1-2 tbsp pure black seed oil
- Optional: 1 tbsp coconut oil if scalp is sensitive

APPLICATION

Before shampooing: massage into the scalp with fingertips, small circles, section by section, then rinse thoroughly with shampoo so no oil is left on the scalp.

PRÉPARATION

Warm the oil for a few seconds between your palms. Mix with coconut oil if using.

FRÉQUENCE

2x/week · leave on 30 min to overnight under a bonnet

Recipes 4 to 6

4 • Diluted tea tree ANTIFUNGAL

For: persistent dandruff, yeast — the most scientifically studied option.

INGRÉDIENTS

- 3–5 drops tea tree essential oil
- 2 tbsp carrier oil (jojoba or olive)

APPLICATION

After shampooing, on still-damp scalp: massage in with fingertips, section by section.

PRÉPARATION

ALWAYS dilute the essential oil in the carrier oil — never apply pure to skin. Mix well.

FRÉQUENCE

1–2x/week · leave on 15–20 min then rinse with clean water · patch test on your inner elbow 24h before first use

5 • Pure aloe vera mask SOOTHING

For: itchiness, dry or irritated scalp — the gentlest recipe, safe to use often.

INGRÉDIENTS

- 3–4 tbsp pure aloe vera gel (99%+)

APPLICATION

Before or after shampooing: apply a thin layer directly to the scalp, massage gently (avoid a thick layer, which can dry out and flake).

PRÉPARATION

Nothing to prepare if using ready-made gel — otherwise extract the pulp from a fresh leaf.

FRÉQUENCE

2–3x/week · leave on 20 min if before shampooing, or leave the thin layer in without rinsing

6 • Rhassoul clay mask ABSORBING

For: buildup, excess sebum, dandruff that sticks to the scalp.

INGRÉDIENTS

- 3 tbsp rhassoul (or green clay)
- Warm water
- 1 tsp honey (optional, softens)

APPLICATION

Before shampooing: apply to the scalp and roots, then rinse thoroughly with shampoo so no clay residue is left behind.

PRÉPARATION

Mix the clay with warm water in a non-metal bowl (use a wooden or plastic spoon) until smooth.

FRÉQUENCE

1x/week · leave on 10–15 min max — never let the clay dry out completely, it over-dries the scalp

THE RECAP

Do & Don't

DO

- ✓ Identify your cause before picking a recipe
- ✓ Try 1 recipe for 3-4 weeks before judging
- ✓ Patch test 24h for any essential oil
- ✓ Massage in small circles, never scratch
- ✓ Space out treatments if scalp gets too dry

DON'T

- ✗ Pure essential oil on skin
- ✗ Let clay dry out completely
- ✗ Scratch the scalp (worsens irritation)
- ✗ Stack several recipes the same day
- ✗ Ignore a red/crusty scalp that persists

THE HONEST PROMISE

These recipes calm and space out common dandruff for many women — but they don't replace medical advice if your scalp stays red, crusty, or very irritated after several weeks of consistent care.

GO FURTHER

These 6 recipes are a start. My full guide *Goodbye Dandruff* goes deeper: the 6 types of dandruff, the complete diagnosis, routines by cause, the active ingredients to look for in your products, and a 30-day challenge → schicgirl.me/en/dandruff/ (\$9). Questions? Message me on [Facebook](#) ♥

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